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Preface to the Latest Revised Edition

We have a great pleasure to present the latest revised and enlarged edition of Lucent's General Knowledge within a short span of time. The day by day growing demand indicates general acceptance of the book and the trust of our esteemed readers, especially the candidates taking competitive exams.

General Knowledge is one of the fastest changing subject as the pace of development is very quick, and a knowledge can become stale within a short-period. That's why, the present edition of the book has been thoroughly revised and updated. Each section of the book has been revised in accordance with the questions asked in recent examinations. Besides, some more useful information and material have been appended in History, Geography, Indian Polity and Constitution, Indian Economy, Miscellany etc.

Besides, recognising the growing importance of the specific questions on environment, ecology, bio-diversity etc., and also on art and culture, two new chapters—(i) Environment and (ii) Art and Culture have been added in the book to cater to your need better.

We are grateful to our esteemed readers, some of whose suggestions have been incorporated in this edition. We would welcome still more suggestions for further improvement in the book.

Writers

Preface to the First Edition

We have a great pleasure in presenting this book Lucent's General Knowledge according to the new trends of various competitive exams. This book covers a wide range of general knowledge in a single concise volume. Apart from extensive coverage, we have recognised three main priorities : accurate & up-to-date information; concise & lucid language; and a clear-cut presentation.

The book is divided into 6 sections, namely :

1. Indian History, 2. Geography, 3. Indian Polity and Constitution, 4. Indian Economy, 5. General Science and 6. Miscellany.

Each section of the book has been compiled with utmost care by well-informed persons and specialist of the subject matter. We are quite confident that this book will cater to the needs of a wide range of readers.

Despite having taken all care, some printing errors might be there in the book. Hence valuable suggestions and comments of the readers, teachers and wellwishers are solicited. The feedback will certainly helps us in further improving the book in subsequent editions.

We are thankful to our publisher who has taken great pains to bring out this book. We also express our sincere gratitude to our friends, family members and all our wellwishers for their useful suggestions, sincere support and kind co-operation.

Buddha Purnima
May 02, 2007

Writers

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Introduction

What is History ?

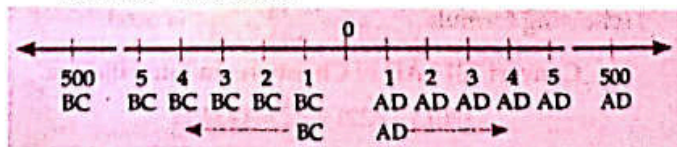
- > The study of the past is called 'History'.
- > The English word 'History' is derived from the Greek word 'historia'. meaning research, inquiry or investigation.
- > The Greek historian Herodotus (484 BC-425 BC) was the first real historian of the world. He wrote only one book 'The Histories' (430 BC). 'The Histories' describes the background and events of the Graeco-Persian/ Greek-Iranian Wars. It was the Roman philosopher Cicero (106 BC-43 BC) who first of all called Herodotus 'The Father of History'.
- > The German historian Leopold von Ranke (1795-1886 AD) is known as 'The Father of Modern History'. According to Ranke, the task of a historian is to describe the past as it actually was [*'wie es eigentlich gewesen'* (German words)—what it (the past) actually was (English translation)].
- > The German philosopher & propounder of 'Thesis-Antithesis-Synthesis' theory Hegel (1770-1831 AD) once said 'History repeats itself', later on German economist and philosopher Karl Marx (1818-83 AD) extended the line : "History repeats itself, first as tragedy, second as farce."
- > According to British historian E. H. Carr (1892-1982 AD): "History is a continuous process of interaction between the Historian and his facts, an unending dialogue between the present and the past".

A System of Dating

- > BC and AD : BC is the acronym of Before Christ. This is an English phrase meaning 'Before the birth of (Jesus) Christ'. So, the years before the birth of Jesus Christ is known as 'Before Christ' and it is denoted as BC in short. e.g. : Gautama Buddha was born in 563 BC and died in 483 BC. Alexander the Great was born in 356 BC and died in 323 BC.

AD is the acronym of Anno Domini. This is a Latin phrase meaning 'In the year of the Lord (Jesus Christ)'. So, the years beginning with the birth of Jesus Christ is known as 'Anno Domini', and it is denoted as AD in short. e.g. : Jesus Christ was crucified in 30 AD. Kushana ruler Kanishka ascended the throne in 78 AD. Hazrat Muhammad was born in 570 AD and died in 632 AD.

- > Time Line : The line displaying the events of past time is called 'Time Line'.



From the above-mentioned time line, it is clear that the years before the birth of Christ are counted backward, viz. ... ←500 BC ←...←5 BC←4 BC← 3 BC←2 BC←1 BC. The meaning of one year before 1 BC is 2 BC, the meaning of one year before 2 BC is 3 BC, the meaning of one year before 3 BC is 4 BC, the meaning of one year before 4 BC is 5 BC. In other words, firstly the year of 5 BC passed, after that 4 BC came, after that 3 BC, after that 2 BC and lastly 1 BC appeared. In the mathematical language, it is like backward counting (100,99,98, and so on). Now if anyone raises a question that which year is the first one and which year is the last one in 500 BC and 2000 BC. Then right answer will be 2000 BC is the first one and 500 BC is the last one. It means firstly 2000 BC passed and after that 500 BC appeared.

From the above-mentioned time line, it is also clear that the years after the birth of Jesus Christ are counted forward. It implies that the meaning of one year after 1 AD is 2 AD, one year after 2 AD is 3 AD, one year after 3 AD is 4 AD, one year after 4 AD is 5 AD. In the mathematical language, it is like forward counting (1, 2, 3 and so on). Now if anyone raises a question that which year is the first one and which year is the last one in 500 AD and 2000 AD then right answer will be 500 AD is the first one and 2000 AD is the last one. It means firstly the year 500 AD passed and after that 2000 AD appeared.

- > Time Glossary : The glossary relating to time is known as 'Time Glossary'.

Some important terms associated with time are—

Decade	The period of 10 years
Quarter (of a century)	One fourth part, Quarter (25 years) of a century
First Half (of a century)	First 50 years of a century i.e. the period from 1st year to 50 th year
Second Half (of a century)	Last 50 years of a century i.e. the period from 51st year to 100 th year
Century	The period of 100 years
Millennium	The period of 1,000 years
Circa—Ca. /C.	If the exact date is not known then the word 'circa' is used with the date. In short, Circa is denoted as Ca. or C. Example : C. 1,500 BC-600 BC: The Vedic Culture Period means that the exact date of Vedic Culture Period is not known but it (C. 1500 BC-600 BC) is some where close to that.

- > First decade of 20th century AD means—
the period from 1901 AD to 1910 AD.
- > Fifth decade of 20th century AD means—
the period from 1941 AD to 1950 AD.
- > Eighth decade of 20th century AD means—
the period from 1971 AD to 1980 AD.
- > Last decade of 20th century AD means—
the period from 1991 AD to 2000 AD.
- > First quarter of 20th century AD means—
the period from 1901 AD to 1925 AD.
- > Fourth or last quarter of 20th century AD means—
the period from 1975 AD to 2000 AD.

- > First half of 20th century AD means—
from 1901 AD to 1950 AD.
Second half of 20th century AD means—
from 1951 AD to 2000 AD.
- > 6th century BC means — 600 BC to 501 BC
4th century BC means — 400 BC to 301 BC
16th century AD means — 1501 AD to 1600 AD
20th century AD means — 1901 AD to 2000 AD
- > Second Millenium BC — 2000 BC–1001 BC
First Millenium BC — 1000 BC–1 BC
First Millenium AD — 1 AD–1000 AD
Second Millenium AD — 1001 AD–2000 AD

Important Eras

Name of the Era	Reckoned from	Remarks
Kali	3102/3101 BC	began 20 years after the end of Mahabharata War.
Saptarshi/Laukika	3077/3076 BC	started after the expiry of 25 Kali year.
Buddhist	544 BC	To commemorate the parinirvana of Buddha
Jain	527 BC	To commemorate the parinirvana of Mahavir
Vikrama/Krita/Malawa	58/57 BC	commenced by Vikramaditya, the local king of Ujjayini (Malawa), to commemorate the victory over the Sakas.
Saka	78 AD	commenced by Kushan ruler Kanishka, on the occasion of his ascendance to the throne. Saka era is known as Saliwahana Sakabda in South India. The Government of India adopted Saka Era along with the Gregorian Calendar (i.e. Julian Calendar/Christian Calendar) as National Calendar on 22 March, 1957 (1 st Chaitra 1879 Saka).
Kalchuri	248 AD	founded by Abhir king Ishwar Sen, later on used by Traikutaka ruler and Kalchuris of Chedi.
Gupta	319-20 AD	founded by Gupta ruler Chandragupta-I, on the occasion of his ascendance to the throne. After the fall of the Guptas, the Maitrakas of Valabhi used this era with a new name Valabhi Samvata. The beginning of Gupta era was fixed by J.F. Fleet in 1887 AD.
Banga/Bengali	593 AD	To mark the ascent of Shashanka, ruler of Bengal
Harsha	606 AD	founded by Harshavardhana of Kannauj, to pronounce his ascendance to the throne.
Hijri	622 AD	founded by Umar, the second Caliphate of Khilafat empire, to commemorate the hijrat from Macca to Madina by Hazrat Muhammad.
Kollam	825 AD	an era that is in use in Malabar (Kerala).
Nevari/Nepali	879 AD	founded by Jaydeo Mall.
Chalukya-Vikrama	1076 AD	founded by Vikramaditya—VI, the Chalukya ruler of Kalyani, on the occasion of his ascendance to the throne.
Lakshmana	1119 AD	founded by Sen ruler of Bengal Lakshmana Sen.
Sikh/Nanakshahi	1469 AD	To commemorate the birth of Guru Nanak

Name of the Era	Reckoned from	Remarks
Ilahi	1556 AD	founded by Mughal ruler Akbar in 1584 AD, but in 1658 AD Aurangzeb abolished the use of Ilahi era.
Raj Saka	1674 AD	founded by Maratha Chhatrapati Shivaji to pronounce his ascendance to the throne.

Note :

1. Development sequence of Gregorian Calendar :
Julian Calendar
(introduced in 46 BC by Roman King Julius Caesar)



- Christian Calendar
(introduced in 527 AD by Monk Dionysius Exiguus)



- Gregorian Calendar
(introduced in 1582 AD by Roman Pope Gregory—XIII)
Gregorian Calendar is modified form of Christian Calendar and Christian Calendar is modified form of Julian Calendar. It means these Calendars are loosely synonyms to one other.

2. Era (English) = Samvata (Sanskrit) = San (Arabic)
3. The eras, except Vikrama, Saka and Hijri era, are either vanished in course of time or still in use in specific regions.
4. National Calendar : Saka Samvata is used in some government sectors customarily (officially), where as Gregorian Calendar is used everywhere practically.
5. Every religion/region has his own calender (esp for religious/regional festivals & fairs)

- > Conversion of Eras : With the help of above mentioned table, any era can be converted into other era.

Conversion of AD of Christian era in Vikrama era : For conversion of AD era in Vikrama era, 57 is added to AD.
e.g. Convert 2013 AD into Vikrama era.

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \text{AD} & & \text{Vikrama} \\ 2013 & + & 57 = 2070 \end{array}$$

Conversion of Vikrama era into AD era : To find AD era from Vikrama era, 57 is subtracted from Vikrama era.
e.g. Convert 2070 Vikrama era into AD era.

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \text{Vikrama} & & \text{AD} \\ 2070 & - & 57 = 2013 \end{array}$$

Conversion of AD era into Saka era : To get Saka era from AD era, 78 is subtracted from AD.
e.g. Convert 2013 AD into Saka era.

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \text{AD} & & \text{Saka} \\ 2013 & - & 78 = 1935 \end{array}$$

Conversion of Saka era into AD era : To find equivalent AD era from Saka era, 78 is added to Saka era.
e.g. Convert 1935 Saka era into AD era.

$$\begin{array}{rcl} \text{Saka} & & \text{AD} \\ 1935 & + & 78 = 2013 \end{array}$$

Conversion of AD of Christian era into Hijri era : To calculate Hijri era from AD of Christian era, the following formula $(C - 622) \times \frac{33}{32} = \dots H$ is used.

e.g. Convert 2013 AD of Christian era into Hijri era.

$$(2013 - 622) \times \frac{33}{32} = 1434 H$$

Conversion of Hijri era into AD of Christian era :
To calculate AD of Christian era from Hijri era, the following formula $(H \times \frac{32}{33}) + 622 = \dots C$ is used.

e.g. Convert 1434 Hijri era into AD of Christian era.

$$(1434 \times \frac{32}{33}) + 622 = 2013 C$$

Period

Bipartite Division : History is generally divided into two periods—Pre-Historic and Historic. The period that has no written evidences is called **Pre-Historic Period** and the period that has written evidences is known as **Historic Period**. In other words, the period before the beginning of writing is called Pre-Historic Period and the period after the beginning of writing is known as Historic Period. The time period of Pre-Historic Period is accepted as 30,00,000 BC to 600 BC and the time period of Historic Period as 600 BC to till date.

Tripartite Division : Tripartite division of History is more prevalent in practice. According to this, History is divided into three periods—Pre-Historic, Proto-Historic and Historic.

Name of the Period	Time Period	Definition & Example
Pre-Historic Period	30,00,000 BC – 2,500 BC	The period for which no written evidence is available. e.g. : Lithic (Stone) Period
Proto-Historic Period	2,500 BC – 600 BC	The period for which written evidence is available but either their script (used in the documents) has not been deciphered or their written documents have not been confirmed with archaeological evidences. e.g. Indus Civilization and Vedic Culture. In the case of Indus Civilization, we have not yet been able to decipher their script, and in the case of Vedic Culture, we have not suffice archaeological evidences to confirm written evidences of that period.
Historic Period	600 BC – till date	The period for which written evidences is available. e.g. Mahajanapada Period to Till Date.

Chronology

German historian **Christoph Cellarius** (1638–1707 AD) was the first historian who gave us tripartite division of History. He divided history into three periods—Ancient, Medieval and Modern History. After him, this tripartite division became standard (model) for history-writing or reading.

For convenience to study, Indian History is divided into four periods—

Ancient India	the beginning—647 AD i.e. from Lithic (Stone) Period to death of Harsha
Medieval India	647–1757 i.e. from death of Harsha to the Battle of Plassey
Modern India	1757–1990 i.e. from the Battle of Plassey to Globalization
Post modern India	1991–till date i.e. from Globalization to till date

Ancient India : the Beginning—647 AD

Pre-Historic Period	30,00,000 BC–600 BC
Indus Civilization	2,500 BC–1750 BC
Vedic Culture	1,500 BC–600 BC
Mahajanapada Period	600 BC–322 BC

Maurya Period	322 BC–185 BC
Post-Maurya / Pre-Gupta Period	185 BC–319 AD
Gupta Period	319 AD–550 AD
Post-Gupta Period / Vardhana Dynasty	550 AD – 647 AD

Note : On the basis of tools, Pre-Historic Period is divided into three sub-periods—Lithic (Stone) Period, Copper Period & Iron Period.

Medieval Period : 647–1757

Early Medieval Period	647–1206
Sultanate Period	1206–1526
Mughal Period	1526–1707

Modern Period : 1757–1990

Stages of British Colonialism

First Phase	The Mercantile Phase	1757–1813	Monopoly of trade & Direct appropriation of revenue
Second Phase	The Industrial Phase	1813–1858	Period of <i>Laissez Fair</i> i.e. Free Trade
Third Phase	The Financial Phase	1860–1947	Finance Imperialism (Period of British capital investment in India)

British Policy towards Native States of India

Ring Fence Policy	1757–1813
Subordinate Isolation Policy	1813–1858
Subordinate Union Policy	1858–1935
Equal Federation Policy	1935–1947

National Movement

First Phase of Congress	1885–1905	Moderate Phase
Second Phase of Congress	1905–1917	Extremist Phase
Third Phase of Congress	1917–1947	Gandhian Era

Ancient India

1. Historical Sources

- > The sources that give information about the events of past time are known as 'Historical Sources'.
- > There are two types of historical sources—Literary Sources and Archaeological Sources. Compared to Literary sources Archeological sources are believed to be more reliable, because it is almost impossible to change them. That's why, as historical evidence, the archaeological sources take precedence over the literary sources.
- > The Archeological sources are more important to the study of Ancient India.

I. Literary Sources

Literary sources are divided into two categories—Indigenous and Foreign.

A. Indigenous Sources

Indigenous sources are divided into two categories—Religious and Secular. Under Religious texts Brahmanic (Hindu) texts, Buddhist texts and Jain texts are included. Under Secular texts Historical texts, Semi-Historical texts, Biographical texts etc are included.

Brahmanic (Hindu) Texts

- > Under Brahmanic (Hindu) texts Shruti & Smriti texts are included.

1. Shruti Texts: Samhitas or Vedas, Brahmanas, Aranyakas & Upanishadas.

2. **Smriti Texts** : Vedangas or Sutras, Smrities, Epics (Ramayana & Mahabharata) and Purans.

- There are four Samhitas or Vedas—Rig Veda, Yajur Veda, Sama Veda & Atharva Veda.

Samhita/Veda	Composing Time	Composing Region
Rig Veda	1,500 BC–1,000 BC	Sapta Saindhav region
Yajur, Sam & Atharva veda	& 1,100 BC–600 BC	Kuru–Panchala region

Vedas throw more light on religious, social & economic life and less light on political life of the Aryans. From point of view of history Rig Veda & Atharva Veda have more importance than Yajur Veda & Sama Veda.

- The composing time of Brahmanas is 1,000 BC to 600 BC. Shatapatha Brahmana throws light on Gandhar, Shalya, Kekaya etc of North-West region and Kuru-Panchala, Koshala, Videha states of East region of India.
- The composing time of Aranyakas is 1,000 BC to 600 BC. The historical importance of Aranyakas is negligible.
- The composing time of Upanishadas is 1,000 BC to 500 BC. The best learnings of Upanishadas is 'Para-vidya' i.e., Spiritual learning. The aim of life is merging the individual's soul into world's soul which is known as 'Para-vidya'.
- The combined study of Brahmanas & Upanishadas provides historical information from king Parikshit to king Bimbisara.
- The composing time of Vedangas is 600 BC to 200 AD. The Vedangas throw light on ancient Indian history, civilization & culture.
- The composing time of Smritis is 600 BC to 600 AD. The Smritis provide the knowledge of social organisations, their theories, customs, king's rights & duties, king's relation with their subjects, etc.
- The composing time of Epics (Ramayana and Mahabharata) is 400 BC to 400 AD.
- The Ramayana (Valmiki) throws light on political, social and religious conditions of India of that time. This book provides information about the origin & development of Janapadas. Besides this, it mentions Yavanas (Greeks) & Sakas (Scythians).
- The Mahabharata (Ved Vyas) throws light on political, social & religious conditions of India of that time. It is the extensive form of Mahabharata war which is fought around 950 BC between the Kauravas & Pandavas. The Mahabharata claims : "Yann Bharate Tann Bharate" i.e., which is not in 'Mahabharata' that is not found in Bharat (India). Girivraja, the capital of Magadha is mentioned in it. The Mahabharata informs us that the Panchala state was in existence from the time of Mahabharata. Besides this, it mentions Huns along with Yavanas & Sakas.
- The composing time of Purans is 400 BC to 400 AD. The Purans throw light on the history of India from very beginning to Gupta period. Generally Purans have 5 segments—Sarga (Creation of the Universe), Pratisarga (Re-creation), Vamsa (Genealogy of the gods and the sages), Manvantar (Epochs of Manu) & Vansanucharitam (narratives of ancient dynasties) in which only Vansanucharitam is important from point of view of history. Unfortunately Vansanucharitam are

not found in every purans. The only Purans that have Vansanucharitams are—Matsya, Bhagawat, Vishnu, Vayu, Brahma, Bhavishya & Garud Puran. Garud Puran has genealogies of Purava, Ikshwaku & Brahadrath dynasties, but its date is not definite.

Buddhist Texts

- The Buddhist texts are divided into two categories—Pali texts & Anupali Texts.
- Among Pali texts 'Tripitaka', 'Deep Vansha' & 'Mahavansha', 'Milindpanna' etc are important texts.
- The 'Tripitaka' is the earliest and the most important texts among Pali Texts. The 'Tripitaka' comprises 'Vinaya Pitaka', 'Sutta Pitaka' & 'Abhidhamma Pitaka'. The 'Vinaya Pitaka' & the 'Sutta Pitaka' were compiled in the First Buddhist Council (483 BC) held in Rajagriha (Bihar) while the 'Abhidhamma Pitaka' was compiled in the third Buddhist Council (250 BC) held in Pataliputra (Bihar). The 'Tripitaka' throws light on social and religious life of India of that time i.e; the centuries before Christ.
- 'Vinaya Pitaka' contains disciplinary rules & regulations for leading a monastic life.
- 'Sutta Pitaka' is the largest and the most important text among Tripitaka. 'Ambattha Sutta' of Digh Nikaya of Sutta Pitaka contains the description of the special pride of Kshatriya for blood-purity. 'Anguttara Nikaya' of Sutta Pitaka contains the list of 16 Mahajanpadas. 'Jataka' of Khuddaka Nikaya of Sutta Pitaka contains 549 folk tales of the previous births of Gautama Buddha. The compilation of 'Jataka' had begun in 1st Century BC. This fact is very clear from the scenarios carved on the railings of Bharahuta & Sanchi Stupas. The verse part of Jataka is older than the prose part. The compilation of the verse part of the Jataka had been completed up to 2nd Century AD. Though 'Jataka' is a religious & cultural text, it throws suffice light on social & economic conditions of that time.
- 'Abhidhamma Pitaka' deals with the doctrines of the Buddha in scholastic manner.
- 'Deep Vansha' (4th Century AD) & 'Maha Vansha' (5th Century AD) had been compiled in Sri Lanka. Though these texts contain the history of Sri Lanka, they throw light on ancient Indian history, especially these are very helpful in constructing Mauryan history.
- Originally 'Milindpanna' i.e., Questions of Milind is a dialogue between Greek king Milind (identified as Menander, the Indo-Greek ruler) and Buddhist monk Nagasena (identified as Nagarjuna) on philosophical matter, but it throws suffice light on religious, social & economic life of North-West India of 1st-2nd century AD. The political condition of that time is mentioned occasionally in it. The foreign trade of India is lively described in it.
- Among Anupali Texts (i.e; Sanskrit Texts & other texts) 'Divyavadan', 'Aryamanjushrimulka', 'Lalit Vistar' etc. are important texts.
- 'Divyavadan' contains the stories of later Mauryan kings & Shunga king (Pushyamitra Shunga) and life of Gautam Buddha.
- Political events of Pre-Mauryan period to Vardhana period (Harshavardhana) are described occasionally in 'Aryamanjushrimulka'.

- 'Lalit Vistar' contains the acts of Gautama Buddha along with religious and social conditions of that time.

Jain Texts

- The Jain Texts throw light on religious & social conditions of that time.
- The Jain texts were eventually compiled in 6th century AD in 2nd Jain Mahasabha held at Vallabhi in Gujarat.
- Among the Jain texts 12 Angas are important. The 'Acharanga Sutra' contains disciplinary rules & regulations for Jain monks. 'Bhagawati Sutra' throws light on the life of Mahavira and contains the list of 16 Mahajanapadas. 'Namadhamma Katha Sutra' contains the preachings of Mahavira. 'Antagada-dasao' & 'Anutarovavaiyadasao' contain life stories of famous Jain monks. 'Vivagasuyam Sutra' contains discussion on Karma Phala i.e. fruits of actions.
- 'Bhadrabahu Charita' contains the life-sketch of Jain Acharya Bhadrabahu along with the glimpses of the later life of Mauryan king Chandragupta Maurya.
- From point of view of history, the 'Parishishtaparva' written by Jain Acharya Hemchandra has the most important place among Jain Texts.

- Although there is no such text of ancient India that can be properly called historical text, because almost every text had been written in a literary or religious colour, but there are some certain texts in which some historical material are available in a dispersed manner.

- Kautilya's 'Arthashastra' was compiled in 4th century BC. It gives not only detailed information about the system of administration, but also an idea of the social and religious life of the people of that time. It is comparable with Aristotle's 'Politics' and Machiavelli's 'Prince'.

- Kamandaka's 'Neetisar' (4th-6th century AD) throws some light on the monarchy of Gupta Period.

- Shukra's 'Shukraneetisar' throws some light on the monarchy of that time.

- Somdev Suri's 'Neetisar Neetivakyamrita' gives information about state machinery of that time.

- Brihaspati's 'Brahmasapatya Arthashastra' is a text in Kautilya's 'Arthashastra' tradition.

- The best example of the earliest historical writing is provided by 'Rajatarangini' (i.e. the stream of kings) written by Kalhana in the 12th century AD. It is a string of biographies of the kings of Kashmir. It may be the first work to possess several characteristics of historical writing as it is understood today. In the words of eminent historian R.C. Majumdar: "There is only one historical work, properly so called, written by Kalhana in 12th Century A.D. This is 'Rajatarangini' which deals with the history of Kashmir from the earliest times up to the date of composition of that work (i.e. 1148-50 AD). It assumes, however, a regular historical form only from the 7th Century A.D. the earlier chapter being a medley of confused traditions and fanciful imaginations".

- The chronicles of Gujarat—'Prabandh Kosh' (Rajashekhara), 'Hammir Mad Mardan' (Jai Singh) 'Tejpal Prashasti' (Vastupal), 'Prabandha Chintamani' (Meruttung) etc throw light on the history of Gujarat.

- The most remarkable text among the chronicles of Sindh is 'Chachanama'. In 8th Century AD Qazi Ishmail, qazi of Alor appointed by Muhammad Bin Qasim, wrote a book namely 'Tarikh-i-Sind-wa-Hind' (i.e., History of Sind or Hind) in Arabic language which is translated in Persian language by the name of 'Chachanama' by Ali Bin Hamid Kufi in 1216 A.D. The 'Chachanama' is also known as 'Fatehnama-i-Sindh'. It provides detailed description of Muhammad Bin Qasim's Sindh conquest (711-12 AD)

Semi-Historical Texts

- Though Panini's 'Ashtadhyayi' is a grammar book, it throws suffice light on political condition of Pre-Maurya & Maurya period.
- Sage Gargi's 'Gargi Samhita' is a part of 'Yug Puran'. It is basically a Jyotish text but it also mentions Greek and Scythian invasions.
- Patanjali's 'Mahabhashya' is basically a commentary book on Panini's 'Ashtadhyayi', but it also provide ample historical material regarding that time.
- Kalidasa's 'Malvikagnimitra' is a play (drama). It is the first play written by him. It provides information about political condition of Shunga dynasty and previous royal dynasties. It is called the mirror of interior life of royal dynasties.
- Vishakhadatta's 'Mudrarakshasa' is basically a drama, but it contains the description of Chandragupta Maurya, his prime minister Chanakya and some contemporary kings. It describes how Chandragupta Maurya got Chanakya's assistance and overthrow the Nandas. Besides this, it gives an excellent account of the prevailing socio-economic conditions of that time.

Biographical Texts

- Biographical writers took lives of their royal patrons as the theme of their literary works. So the biographical texts cannot be regarded as genuine history although they contain some valuable historical information. Their main object was the glorification of the king rather than giving a real picture of his life and times. That's why these are called 'Prashasti Kavya' i.e. eulogy verse.

- Banabhatta composed 'Harsha Charita' based on the life of his patron king Harshavardhana in 620 AD. It is the earliest available biographical text in India. It is written in Sanskrit language. It contains 8 Uchchawas i.e. chapters. The first 3 chapters contain the autobiography of Banabhatta and rest 5 chapters contain the life-story of Harshavardhana. Though highly exaggerated, it gives us excellent idea of court life under Harshavardhana and the social and religious life in his time.

- Vakpatiraj's 'Gaudvaho' (GaudVadhah) contains detailed description of victories of Yashovarmana, the Chandra ruler of Kannauj in which the most important event described is killing (Vadha) of Gaud king by King of Kannauj, Yashovarmana.

- Padmagupta Parimal's 'Navasahasanka Charita' describes the life-story of Vakpati Munj, the Paramara ruler of Malwa.

- Ballal's 'Bhoja Prabandha' contains the life-story of Bhoja, the Paramara ruler of Malwa.

- Bilhana's 'Vikramanka Charita' recounts the achievements of his patron Vikramaditya-VI (Vikramanka), the Chalukya King of Kalyani. It describes the circumstances in which Vikramaditya-VI (Vikramanka) ascended the throne of Kalyani.
- Sandhyakar Nandin's 'Ramcharita' throws light on the history of Pala dynasty. Nandin called himself 'Valmiki of Kali Yuga' and his patron Rampala as 'Rama'. Nandin wrote this book in an extraordinary style it simultaneously narrates the story of Rama, the hero of 'Ramayana' and Rampala, the Pala king. Such style of verse (poetry) is known as 'Dvyasraya Kavya' i.e. a verse with two bases (meanings).
- Hemachandra's Sanskrit-Prakrit text 'Kumarpala Charita' describes Kumarpala, the Chaulukya Solanki ruler of Anihawara. It is also a 'Dvyasraya Kavya'. It simultaneously narrates the story of the king Kumarpala and rules of Sanskrit & Prakrit grammar.
- Jay Singh Suri's 'Kumarpala Bhupala Charita' describes Kumarpala, the Chaulukya ruler of Anihawara.
- Anand Bhatt's 'Ballalcharita' describes the history of Ballal Sena, the Sena ruler of Bengal.
- Chandbardai was a court poet and friend of Prithviraja-III, the Chauhan ruler of Shakambhari. He wrote 'Prithviraja Raso'; the first epic of Hindi language. 'Prithviraja Raso' describes the life-account of Prithviraja-III and conflict between Prithviraja-III & Muhammad Ghori.
- Jayanaka's 'Prithviraja Vijaya' contains poetic description of struggles of Prithviraja-III, the Chauhan ruler.
- Jayachandra's 'Hammir Kavya' describes the life-account of Hammir Dev, the Chauhan ruler of Ranathambhore.
- Rajanath-II's 'Achyutarajabhyudaya' throws light on Achyutadeva Ray, the Tuluva ruler of Vijayanagar.

Court Poets & Their Patron Kings

Court Poet	Patron King (Dynasty)
Banabhatta	Harshavardhana : 606-47 (Vardhana)
Vakpatiraja	Yashovarmana : 700-40 (Chandra)
Padmagupta Parimal	Vakpatimunj : 973-96 (Parmara)
Vallabha	Bhoja : 1010-55 (Parmara)
Bilhana	Vikramaditya-VI : 1076-1126 (Chalukya)
Sandhyakar Nandin	Rampala : 1077-1120 (Pala)
Hemachandra	Kumarpala : 1088-1172 (Chaulukya/Solanki)
Jai Singh Suri	Kumar Pala : 1088-1172 (Chaulukya/Solanki)
Anand Bhatta	Balladsena : 1158-78 (Sena)
Chandbardai	Prithviraja-III : 1178-92 (Chauhana)
Jayanaka	Prithviraja-III : 1178-92 (Chauhana)
Nayachandra	Hammirdeva : 1283-1301 (Chauhana)
Rajanath-II	Achyutadeva Ray : 1529-42 (Tuluva)

B. Foreign Sources

- Indigenous sources can be supplemented by foreign sources. The writings of foreign travellers and chroniclers provide valuable sources of ancient Indian history; of these, some visited India and some others who never visited India (like Herodotus, Ktesias, Pliny, Justin, Siyab al Dinumari etc) but based their accounts on informations received from different sources.

- To India came Greek, Chinese, Tibetan, Arabian (Arab) visitors, merchants, ambassadors, historians, pilgrims, travellers etc and some of them left behind accounts of the things that they saw.
- These accounts help in the writing of Indian history, especially in resolving the problem of chronology. These have been found immensely useful in building up the framework of Indian chronology.
- Foreign sources can be divided into four categories—Greek-Roman, Chinese, Tibetan & Arabian (Arab).

Greek Writers

- It is remarkable that Alexander's invasions find no mention in Indian sources and it is totally on the basis of the Greek sources that we have to reconstruct the history of his Indian invasions.
- The names of Greek writers of Pre-Alexandrian time are—Scylax, Hecataeus Milletus, Herodotus & Ktesias.
- **Scylax** (6th Century BC) was the first Greek writer who wrote about India. He was the Greek soldier of king Darius-I (550 BC-486 BC) of Persia (Iran). He was sent by the king to discover the course of Indus river. He wrote his travel account but his knowledge was limited to Indus valley.
- **Hecataeus Milletus** (549 BC-496 BC) was a Greek historian and geographer. His knowledge about India was limited to Indus Valley.
- **Herodotus** (484 BC-425 BC) is called 'the father of history'. He, in his famous text 'Histories', gives us suffice information about Persian (Iranian) and Greek invasion and Indo-Persian/Iranian relations. Although he never visited India, he tells us about the political condition of North-West India in his time. He knew of India as the easternmost and the most numerous people inhabiting the empire of the Persian emperor, Darius-I. The land region of Northern India, 20th satrapy (i.e. province) of Darius's empire, paid him the huge annual tribute of 360 talents gold dust. He writes that Indians wear clothes, made of wool, which grows on tree. It proves that, long before the christian era, Indians were familiar with the cultivation of cotton, and made use of the cotton fibre to weave their clothes when Greeks knew nothing about it. Herodotus sometimes could be led away from the truth that can be seen from his account of gold-digging ants of the size of dogs.
- **Ktesias** (416 BC-398 BC) was a Greek physician at the court of Persian emperor Artaxaxes Mhemon. He had every opportunity of knowing the stories about India but he has left an account titled 'Persica' which is full of lies and exaggerations. It has survived only in the form of an abridgement.
- The names of Greek writers of Alexandrian time are—Nearchus, Onesicritus & Aristobulus.
- **Nearchus** was the classmate and Admiral of navel fleet of Alexander the Great. He was sent by Alexander to discover the coastal area between Persian Gulf and Indus. His original book has been lost, but the later writers like Strabo, Arrian etc. quoted passages from the original book.

- **Onesicritus** was the Pilot of naval fleet of Alexander the Great. He took part in the expedition of Nearchus and wrote a book about India. He also wrote the biography of Alexander the Great.
- **Aristobulus** was a geographer. Alexander gave him some responsibilities. He described his own experiences in the book 'the History of War'. Later Greek writer Arrian has utilised his account in the 'Anabasis of Alexander'.
- The names of *Greek writers of Post-Alexandrian time* are—Megasthenes, Deimachus, Dionysios, Patrocles, Timosthenes, Aelian, Diodorus, Strabo, Plutarch, anonymous Greek writer of 'Periplus', Arrian & Kosmos/Cosmas Indicopleustes.
- **Megasthenes** (350 BC–290 BC) was a Greek ambassador (envoy) sent by Seleucus Nicator, the Greek king of Persia (Iran) & Babylonia, to the court of Chandragupta Maurya, the founder of Maurya Dynasty where he resided up to 6 years (302 BC–296 BC). He wrote a book on India called 'Indica'. The original book has been lost but later writers like Diodorus, Strabo, Pliny (Roman), Arrian, Justin etc preserved the passages from the original book and those passages have been collected to give an idea as to what Megasthenes thought about India. Those passage have been translated into English by Mc Crindle. The information given by Megasthenes is quite detailed on certain points. Among other things, he described—
 - (a) The geographical features of India,
 - (b) The fertility of the country,
 - (c) Patliputra, the capital of Chandragupta Maurya,
 - (d) The absence of slavery in India,
 - (e) The 7 castes of the Indians,
 - (f) The rare occurrence of theft in their country,
 - (g) Indian Philosophers, and
 - (h) The part played by Dionysus and Herakles in India.

Scholars have differed in their estimate of Megasthenes's veracity (truthfulness). In the present state of our knowledge, perhaps it is best to say that, though Megasthenes related what he saw truthfully, there are also things that he reproduced from hearsay.

'Indica' was the first book through which ancient Europe knew about India. Megasthenes was the first ambassador who is mentioned in Indian history.

- **Deimachus** was a Greek ambassador sent by Antiochus-I, the ruler of Syria, to the court of Bindusara, the second Mauryan ruler. His original work has been lost, but later writers preserved passages from the original book.
- **Dionysios** was a Greek ambassador sent by Philadelphus (Ptolemy-II), the ruler of Egypt, to the court of Bindusara, the second Mauryan ruler. His original book is lost, only passages have survived in the writing of later Greek writers.
- **Patrocles** (250 BC) was a Greek governor of the Province that lies between Caspian Sea & Indus river under the rulership of Seleucus & Antiochus-I. He described India and other countries in his book.
- **Timosthenes** was the naval admiral of Philadelphus (Ptolemy-II).

- **Aelian** (100 BC) was a Greek historian. His book 'A Collection of Miscellaneous History' contains the description of North-West Province.
- **Diodorus** (died-36 BC) was a famous Greek historian. He is known for 'Bibliotheca Historica'. He wrote about India on the basis of description found in Megasthenes. His book gives suffice information regarding Alexander's invasion and India.
- **Strabo** (64 BC–19 BC) was a Greek historian and geographer. His text 'Geographica' has an important place in History along with Geography. He described geographical condition alongwith social, religious, economic conditions of India. He mentions the marital relationship between Seleucus Nicator & Sandrokottus (identified as Chandragupta Maurya). He mentions women bodyguards of Sandrokottus (Chandragupta Maurya).
- **Plutarch** (45–125 AD)'s book contains the description of the life of Alexander the Great and general introduction of India. He wrote : "When Androkottus (identified as Chandragupta Maurya) was young, he met Alexander the Great".
- The anonymous Greek writer of 'Periplus of the Erythrean Sea/Periplus Maris Erythraei' i.e. sailing around the Red Sea (80–115 AD) made a voyage to the Indian coast about 80 AD and he has left a record of its ports, harbours and merchandise. 'Periplus' gives an idea of the maritime activities of ancient Indians. This text is known as 'a guide of sea trade'. The unknown author of the 'Periplus' claims that Hippalus, a mariner, was knowledgeable about the monsoon winds that shorten the trip from Red Sea to India and India to the Red Sea. It is an important foreign source for Sangam period of South India. It contains the detailed description of trade between Roman empire and the regions of South India during 1st Century AD.
- **Arrian** (130–172 AD) was a famous Greek historian. He wrote two books 'Indica' & 'Anabasis of Alexander' (history of Alexander's campaigns). The account of Arrian has been regarded as the most reliable and authentic account among the accounts of Greek writers concerned with India. In this account Chandragupta Maurya is mentioned as Androkottus.
- **Kosmos/Cosmos Indicopleustes** (537–547 AD) was a Greek merchant who later turned to a Buddhist monk. He sailed down Mediterranean Sea, Red Sea, Persian Gulf, Sri Lanka & India during 537–547 AD. Around 550 AD he wrote 'Christian Topography of the Universe' which contains valuable information about trade between India with Sri Lanka and other countries situated in Western Sea coast.

Roman/Latin Writers

Pliny (23–99 AD) : He was a Roman historian. He was the contemporary of Kushana ruler Kanishka. He wrote an encyclopedic text 'Naturulis Historica' i.e. Natural History. He gives the descriptions of India which is based on informations received from Greeks and other Western merchants. His text contains the detailed description about animals, plants and minerals of India alongwith the trade relation between Rome (Italy) and India.

Curtius (1st Century AD) : He was a Roman historian. He was the contemporary of Roman emperor Claudius (41-54 AD). His book contains suffice information about Alexander the Great.

Ptolemy (2nd Century AD) : He was a Roman geographer & historian. His popular text 'Geographia' i.e. Geography contains information about ancient geography and trade between India and Rome (Italy).

Justin (2nd Century AD) : He was a Roman historian. He wrote a text namely 'Epitome' i.e. summary of a written work. His text is based on Greek accounts. His text contains the description of the Indian campaign of Alexander the Great alongwith power-seizing by Chandragupta Maurya. Justin wrote about the role of Chandragupta Maurya in uprooting Greek power from North-West India : "India after the death of Alexander had shaken, as it were, the yoke of servitude from its neck and put his governors to death. The author of this liberation was Sandrocottus". (Sandrocottus is identified as Chandragupta Maurya)

Chinese Writers

- **Suma Chien** (145 BC-85 BC) was the first Chinese writer who wrote about India in his text 'Historical Memoirs'.
- **Pan Kou & Fanye (378-445 AD)** : 'Annals of the Earlier Hans' written by Pan Kou and 'Annals of the Later Hans' written by Fanye contain valuable information about Kushan rulers Kujul Kadphises and Vem Kadphises.
- **Fa-hien** (399-414 AD) came to India in 399 AD during the reign of Gupta ruler Chandragupta-II 'Vikramaditya'. He stayed in India for 15-16 years (399-414). He came to India basically to cover an original copy of 'Vinaya Pitaka'. After return to China he wrote his travel account namely 'Fo-Kyuo-Ki' i.e. Records of Buddhist Countries. This book is still available in the original form. It throws suffice light on history, civilization & culture of Gupta period. It is written from Buddhist (religious) point of view, so there is a lack of scientific temper.
- **Sung Yun** (518-22 AD) came to India in quest of Buddhist texts and return to China with 170 Mahayana texts.
- **Hiuen Tsang** (629-45 AD) came to India in 629 AD in the reign of Harshavardhana, the ruler of Vardhana dynasty. He stayed in India for 13-14 years (629-45). He studied Yogachar doctrine in Nalanda Mahavihara for 5 years. In 641 AD he reached Kanchi in the reign of Narsingh Varmana-I 'Mammal', the Pallava ruler of Kanchi and stayed there for a long time. He wrote a travel account 'Si-Yu-Ki' (i.e. Buddhist Records of the Western World). The account contains detailed information about history and culture of the country, especially the life of Harshavardhana and his activities, administration, religious, educational system of that time. It is truly a gazetteer. His account is really a store-house of informations that helps to connect the discrete sequences of historic events of India. He also writes about the Huna ruler Mihirkula (a contemporary of Gupta ruler Baladitya, Budhagupta and some others who patronized the Nalanda Mahavihara). He is known as the 'King or Prince of Pilgrims'.
- **Hwui Li** wrote a biography of his friend Hiuen Tsang namely 'life of Hiuen Tsang'. It throws some light on Indian history.

- **Itsing** (673-95 AD) came to India through a sea route via Sumatra. He stayed in Nalanda Mahavihara for 10 years and studied Sanskrit texts and Buddhist texts. He wrote a travel account 'A Record of the Buddhistic Religion as Practised in India and Malay Archipelago'. This text does not give much information about political history of India, but it contains precious information about Sanskrit literature and history of Buddhist religion. Itsing's 'Autobiographies of Famous Buddhist Monks' contains detailed information about social, economic and cultural life of India of that time. Itsing refers to Srigupta, who is generally believed to have been the first ruler of the Gupta dynasty.
- **Hui-Cho** (727 AD) refers to the doings of Muktapida of Kashmir and Yashovarmana of Kannauj.
- **Matwa Lin** (13th Century AD) gives the information about a eastern campaign of Harshavardhana, the Vardhana ruler.
- **Mohaana** (15th Century AD) came to India in 1406 AD. He visited Bengal. He was very impressed to see such an enriched region of India. He praised the manufactured things of Bengal.

Tibetan Writers

- **Taranath** (12th Century AD) was a popular Tibetan historian. He wrote 'Kangyur' & 'Tangyur'. These texts give us information about ancient period of India.
- **Dharmaswamy** (13th Century AD) came to India and studied in Nalanda Mahavihara for 3 years (1234-36 AD).

Arabian/Arabic Writers

- **Sulaiman** (851 AD) was an Arab merchant. He was the first Arab traveller whose travel account is available. He sailed to all coastal areas of India. He came to India in 851 AD during the reign of the Pratihara king Mihir Bhoja-I (836-85 AD). He stayed at the court of Amoghavarsha (815-77 AD), the Rashtrakuta ruler and was very impressed with his might and prosperity. He wrote a book namely 'Silsila--ut-Tawarikh'. He described the conditions of earlier half of 9th Century. He gives an interesting account of Pala, Pratihara & Rashtrakuta kings. He called the Pala empire 'Ruhama' (i.e. Dharma or Dharmapala). He called the Gurjar Pratihara 'Jurz'. He wrote that the Jurz had the finest horses. He called the king of Deccan 'Balhara' (identified as Vallabharaja). He called Hind Mahasagar (Indian Ocean) 'Dariya-i-Hargand'.
- **Ibn Khurdadhbih** (864 AD) was an Arab geographer. He wrote a book namely 'Kitab-al-Masalik-wa-Mamalik' i.e. the Book of Roads and Kingdoms. In this book he gives important information about inter-communication system of the 9th Century. He was the first person among Arab geographers who speaks about the seven castes of Hindus.
- **Al Biladuri** (died-892 AD) wrote 'Futuh-ul-Buldan'. It describes the Sindh conquest by Arabs (Muhammad bin Qasim).
- **Al Masudi** (died-956 AD) was an Arab traveller. He visited India in 915 AD during the reign of Gurjar Pratihara king Malipala-I. He called the Gurjar dynasty 'Al Gujar' and their rulers 'Barua'. He wrote 'Muruz-

ul-Jahab'. In this text, he described horses and camels of Mahipala-I, the Pratihara king. He described 'Paan' (beetal leaf) in detail. He gives a fairly good account of Arab principalities of Multan and Mansura.

- **Ibn Hawkal** (943-79 AD) was a merchant of Baghdad. He came from Baghdad to India via different regions of Europe and Africa. He visited the state of Rashtrakutas. He wrote 'Askal-al-vilad'. He made a cartographic map of Sindh. He was the first person among Arab geographers who attempted to define the length and breadth of India. This was the first attempt by any foreigner to define the boundaries of India.
- **Alberuni** (973-1048 AD) : His full name was Abu Rayhan Muhammad ibn Ahmed Alberuni, but he was popularly known as 'Alberuni' meaning 'Ustad' (i.e., Teacher/Master). He was born in Khwarizm (modern Khiwa) of Uzbekistan. He was captivated by Mahmud Ghaznavi, the sultan of Ghazni during Khiwa battle (1017 AD). Mahmud Ghaznavi brought him Ghazni and was very impressed by his multifarious talent. So, Mahmud Ghaznavi appointed him 'Najumi' (court-astrologer).

In 1019 AD Alberuni came to India with his patron Mahmud Ghaznavi and stayed in Punjab for many years. He learnt Sanskrit language and studied many books concerned with Philosophy and other subjects. He was given the title 'Vidyasagar' (i.e., the ocean of knowledge) by Hindus.

After his return to Ghazni, he compiled a book in Arabic language '**Tehqiq-i-Hind**' (i.e., Enquiry into India or Reality of India) in 1029-30 AD. This book is also called '**Tarikh-i-Hind**' (i.e., History of India) or, '**Kitab-ul-Hind**' (i.e., The Book of India). Like an encyclopedia this book contains detailed information about Indian society and culture and other fields of knowledge. It is believed that this is the best foreign account of India. Such extensive and authentic study of Indian society and culture had not been done before. Therefore, Alberuni is called '**First Real Indologist**'. He was given the title '**The Real founder of Indology**'. (Note : Megasthenes was believed to be the 'Beginner of Indology'.) There are two shortcomings of this book—firstly, Alberuni says practically nothing about the political condition of India during his own times and secondly, he wrote from what he read and not from what he saw. His information is not based on his personal knowledge but on what he read in books. This book has been translated into English namely '**Alberuni's India**' by **Edward C. Sachau**. In the words of **Jarret** : "This book is a magic island of quite impartial research in the midst of a world of clashing swords, burning towns and plundered temples".

- **Ibn Batuta** (1304-69 AD) : The full name of Ibn Batuta was Abu Abdullah Muhammad ibn Abdullah Lawalut-Tangi ibn Batuta. He was born in 1304 AD at Tangier in Morocco of Africa. He was a Moroccan (African) traveller. In 1333 AD, he came to India in the reign of Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq, the Sultan of Delhi Sultanate. Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq welcomed him and appointed Qazi (i.e. Judge) of Delhi. Ibn Batuta held this post up till 1342 AD when he was sent to China as

an ambassador of Delhi Sultanate, but unfortunately he did not reach China due to shipreck. He wrote a travel account of India in which he gives valuable information about life and period of Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq. He described the reasons and the circumstances of transfer of capital from Delhi to Devagiri (Daulatabad). In 1345 AD he stayed in the court of Gayasuddin Muhammad Damghan Shah, the Sultan of Madurai. In 1353 AD he returned to his native place Tangiers in Morocco. In 1355 AD he wrote a book in Arabic language '**Rihla**' (i.e. Travel). He died in 1369 AD.

- **Sihab al Dinumari** (1348 AD) was a resident of Dymascus (Syria). He had never come to India, but on the basis of informations received by the India-returned persons he wrote a book '**Masalika Absari Mamalika Asar**' in 1348 AD. It throws light on the socio-economic conditions.
- **Abdurrazzaq** (1413-82 AD) was born in Herat (Afghanistan) in 1413 AD. He was a Qazi at the court of Shaharukh, the son of Timur Lang and Sultan of Samarkand (Persia). He was sent by Shaharukh as an ambassador to the Zamorin of Calicut in 1442 AD. In April 1443 AD, he visited Vijayanagara during the reign of Devaraya-II. He stayed in the capital city of Vijayanagara for 6 months. He was overawed with the size and grandeur of the city of Vijayanagara. He says: "The city is such that the eye has not seen nor the ear heard of any place resembling it upon the whole earth". He gives valuable information on the topography, administration and social life of Vijayanagara. Besides this, his text '**Malta-us-Sadan-wa-Mazama-ul-Bahrain**' (i.e., the rising of two pious stars and conjuncture of two seas) describes the maritime trade through Hind Mahasagar (Indian Ocean) during 14th-15th centuries.

II. Archaeological Sources

Origin & Development of Indian Archaeology

- In India, archaeology-related activities had been started by Europeans.
- Eminent orientalist **Sir William Jones** (1746-94 AD) founded the Asiatic Society of Bengal (Calcutta) in 1784 AD.
- In the beginning the activities of the Asiatic Society were limited to language & literature, but soon the society had to take notice of archaeology. A large number of inscriptions were collected, but there was a big problem. These inscriptions could not be deciphered because of the ignorance of the script. This problem was solved by **James Prinsep** (1799-1840 AD), a minister of Asiatic Society and founding editor of the journal of the Asiatic Society, by decipherment of the Brahmi script in 1837 AD after strenuous labour of 7 years and after that he succeeded to decipher Ashokan inscriptions. He also deciphered Kharosthi script.

George Turnour (1799-1842 AD), an officer of Ceylon (Sri Lanka) Civil Service, took forward the research work regarding Indian archaeology, by the identification of 'Piyadassi' (Priyadarshi) with Mauryan king 'Ashoka' as mentioned in ancient Buddhist texts.

- **Sir Alexander Cunningham**, a British army engineer deputed in Bengal, was very helpful in explanation-work of James Prinsep.

- Sir Alexander Cunningham (1861-85 AD) was appointed Archaeological Surveyor at the Archaeological Survey of India, New Delhi (founded in 1861 during the reign of Governor General & Viceroy Lord Canning). Cunningham laid the foundation of the Indian Archaeology by his intensive researches in the field of explorations and excavations.
- For his great contribution to Indian archaeology Sir Alexander Cunningham is called the 'Father of Indian Archaeology'.
- In 1885 AD, Cunningham retired from his post. After his retirement James Burgess (1886-89 AD) held the post, but after his retirement in 1889 AD, the chaos spreaded there that prolonged for about 13 years (1889-1902 AD).
- In the early years of 20th century, favourable condition had been established by Governor General & Viceroy Lord Curzon. He set up a separate Department of Archaeology and appointed Sir John Marshall as the Director-General of Archaeological Survey of India in 1902 AD. Marshall held this post for 26 years (1902-28 AD).
- Sir John Marshall with the help of his associates—Dayaram Sahani (Discovery of Harappa-1921), Rakhal Das Bannerji (Discovery of Mohanjodaro-1922), Ernest Mackay (Chanhudaro-1925), Aurel Stein (Sutkagendor-1927)—succeeded firstly to bring to light the ruins of ancient cities. The formal announcement of the discovery of Indus Civilization was made in 1924 by Sir John Marshall. Revealing of Indus Civilization changed the stream of history. In other words, it was the turning-point in Indian history. Now India was placed on global map because it had antique civilization like Iraq (Mesopotamian Civilization), Egypt (Egyptian Civilization) & China (Chinese Civilization). Before Marshall's announcement, it was believed that civilization in India began with Vedic Aryans. The finding of the remains of Indus Civilization disproved this belief. Now the beginning of civilization in India was pushed 2,500 years back. In this way, the antiquity of Indian civilization was established.
- The names of Successors of Sir John Marshall are—H. Hargreaves (1928-31 AD), Dayaram Sahani (1931-35 AD), J.P. Blackiston (1935-37 AD), K.N. Dixit (1937-44 AD), Mortimer Wheeler (1944-48 AD), N.P. Chakrabarti (1948-50 AD) etc.

Kinds of Archaeological Sources

Archaeological sources are categorized into three categories—Inscriptions, Coins & Monuments. The study of inscriptions is known as 'Epigraphy' and the person who studies it as 'Epigraphist'. The study of coins is known as 'Numismatics' and the person who studies it as 'Numismatist'. The Numismatics Society of India was founded in Allahabad in 1910 AD.

A. Inscriptions

- Inscriptions are the most important sources among Archaeological Sources.
- Inscriptions are divided into two groups—Foreign and Indigenous.

Foreign Inscriptions

- **Boghazkoi Inscription (1380 BC)**: Boghazkoi Inscription (Asia Minor, Turkey) was discovered in 1906 AD by German archaeologist Hugo Winckler. This inscription was found in the form of Clay Tablets from Boghazkoi, the capital of ancient Hittites empire. This inscription contains the description of an accord between Hittani & Mittani states and mentions four vedic deities—Indra, Mitra, Varun & Nasatya (i.e. Ashwini Kumar)—as guard-deities of accord. These gods are also mentioned in the Rig Veda. Thus Boghazkoi Inscription proved that Asia Minor was the original homeland of the Aryans. In other words, it confirms the Central Asian Theory. It indicates the transition of Aryans from Central Asia to India via Iran.
- **Behistun Inscription (520-18 BC) & Naqsh-i-Rustam Inscription (515 BC)**: These two inscriptions are concerned with the reign of Persian/Iranian emperor Darius-I. These are found from Behistun & Naqsh-i-Rustam. According to Behistun Inscription, Darius-I annexed the 'Gadar' (i.e. Gandhar) and the 'Shatagu' (i.e. Saptasindhu) and after annexation he constituted this area in 20th Strapi (i.e. province) of his empire. This province was so fertile that from this province the empire received 360 Talent gold dust as revenue (according to Herodotus). According to Naqsh-i-Rustam Inscription, Persian emperor Darius-I possessed the 'Hindu' (i.e. Sindhu) valley.

Iranian inscriptions are written in Persian language and Cuneiform script. Before 1837 AD, Iranian inscriptions were deciphered by Henry Rawlinson (an officer of the British East India Company and deputed in Afghanistan) and others.

It is notable that among Foreign Inscriptions of India, the earliest deciphered inscriptions are Iranian Inscriptions that is Behistun & Naqsh-i-Rustam Inscription. Of course, among Indigenous Inscription, the earliest deciphered inscriptions are Ashokan Inscriptions.

Indigenous Inscriptions

- Some scholars believe that the tradition of Inscription-inscribing (encarving) in India had began before coming of Mauryan King Ashoka. They present two inscriptions as proof of their belief.
- 1. Piprahawa Buddhist Urn/Pot Inscription (Siddharthanagar district, Uttar Pradesh, 5th-4th Century BC).
- 2. Barli Inscription (Ajmer district, Rajasthan)

While some other scholars think that the Inscription-inscribing in India began with Mauryan king Ashoka.

- Whatever be the matter, but it is fairly certain that the golden period of the tradition of inscription-inscribing in India had began with the period of Mauryan king Ashoka.
- Among Indigenous Inscriptions of India the first deciphered inscriptions are Ashokan inscriptions which were deciphered in 1837 by James Prinsep, a civil servant in the employ of the East India Company in Bengal.

I. North Indian Inscriptions

Mauryan Inscriptions

Ashokan Inscription

1. Till date 40 Ashokan inscriptions have been found.
2. In Ashokan inscriptions only Karuwaki among his queens and only Teevar among his children have been mentioned.
3. In Ashokan inscriptions the word 'Pasand' for Sampradaya i.e. community, 'Bambhan' for Brahmana and 'Nigrath' for Nirgranth i.e. Jain have used.
4. Bhabru inscription is the only Ashokan inscription in which Boustrophendon (Bailmutti i.e. writing like piss of an ox) script is used. This script is a bidirectional script i.e. from right to left and left to right in alternate line.
5. In Yerragudi inscription (Andhra Pradesh) the matter of inscription is written in Brahmi script but right to left (Note-Brahmi script is written from left to right direction only).
6. In four Ashokan inscriptions found from Maski, Gurjara, Nittur & Udegolam, the word 'Ashoka' is used for him.
7. Bhabru inscription is the only Ashokan inscription in which Mauryan king Ashoka called himself 'Magadhiraj' i.e. Raja of Magadh.
8. Ashokan Junagadh (Girnar) Major Rock Edict is the inscription on which later Saka ruler Rudradaman (130-50 AD) and Gupta ruler Skandagupta (455-67 AD) inscribed their inscriptions.
9. Ashokan Allahabad Pillar Edict is the inscription on which the inscription of four persons are inscribed—Ashoka, Karuwaki, Samudragupta & Jehangir.
10. The first discovered inscription of Ashoka is Meerut-Delhi Pillar Edict which was discovered in 1750 AD by Joseph Tiefenthaler an European Jesuit Missionary & Geographer.
11. Ashokan inscriptions are generally written in Brahmi script and Prakrit language.
12. Though Prakrit was the language used in Ashokan inscription, the script varied from region to region—Brahmi script in Eastern India, Kharosthi script in North-Western India and Greek & Aramaik scripts in Western India.
13. In Manshera & Shahbaigadhi (both in Pakistan) Inscription Kharosthi script (Script that is written from right to left) is used.
14. In Shara-i-Kuna (Kandhar, Afghanistan) Inscription Greek & Aramaik script is used.
15. Devdatta Ramkrishna (D.R.) Bhandarkar has written a book 'Ashoka' (Published in 1925 AD) which is based only on the inscriptions of Ashoka.

Dasharatha's Nagarjuni Cave Inscription (220 BC): This inscription is found in Nagarjuni hills situated in Jehanabad district of Bihar state. This inscription is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script. According to the inscription, king Dasharatha (grandson of Ashoka) donated three caves namely Vapika, Gopika & Vadithika cave to Ajivika monks so that they could reside in the rainy season.

Post-Mauryan Inscriptions

- > **Heliodorus's Besnagar Garud Pillar Inscription (Second half of 2nd century BC):** This pillar inscription is situated in Besnagar village (Bhilsa district, Madhya Pradesh). This inscribed pillar was erected in front of the Vishnu Temple by Heliodorus (an ambassador sent by Antiochides (115 BC-110 BC), the Indo-Bactrian ruler, to the court of Bhagabhadra, the Shung king).

In this inscription Heliodorus called himself 'Bhagwat' that confirms he was the follower of Bhagwat religion. This pillar was surmounted by a sculpture of Garud and was dedicated to the god Vishnu. It confirms the religious impact of India on Greeks.

- > **Dhanadeo's Ayodhya Stone Inscription (1st Century BC):** It is encaved on a stone-piece which is 1 km away from Ayodhyanaagar in Basti district of Uttar Pradesh state. It is written in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script. It is the earliest available inscription written in Sanskrit language. This was inscribed by Dhanadeo of Shung dynasty. It contains the information about Pushyamitra Shung, founder of Shung dynasty, their capital Ayodhya, Ashwamedha Yajnas performed twice by him, victory over the Greek etc.

- > **Kharavela's Hathigumpha Inscription (1st Century BC):** This inscription is inscribed on the upper part of Hathigumpha (Gumpha is an Odeshi synonym of Hindi word Gupha i.e. cave). It was inscribed by Kharavela, the Cheti/Chedi or Mahameghavahan ruler of Kalinga. It is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script. It throws light on the life of Kharavela, his acts and the events of his reign year by year (from coronation to 13th years of his rule). It described the Kalinga ruler Kharavela and his queen as the patron of Jain religion. Kharavela was a follower of Jain religion and he took up the title 'Bhikshuraj'. This inscription describes how he invaded Magadh and made their king Brihaspatimitra (Shung dynasty) pay homage at his feet. He returned home (i.e. Kalinga) with the statue and the foot-marks of the first Jina (i.e. Rishabhadeva) which had been carried away three centuries ago by king Nanda. The important points among other details of the inscription are—Extension of the old canal (excavated by king Nanda) up to the capital Kalinga from Tanasuliya; Construction of Mahavijaya palace; Construction of a large temple at Bhubaneshwar etc. In this inscription he called himself 'Chakravarti' ruler. This is the first inscription in which the word 'Bharatvarsha' is mentioned.

- > **Nagagnika's Nanaghat Cave Inscription (Second half of 1st Century BC):** This inscription is found from a cave of Nanaghat in Poona (Pune) district of Maharashtra state. It is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script. It was inscribed by Satavahana ruler Shatakarni's wife Nagagnika who was a daughter of Maharathi of Maharashtra. It throws light on the achievements of Shatakarni (20 BC...). In this Inscription Shatakarni is called 'Apratihatchakra' 'Dakshinadhipati', 'Dhan of Simuk Vansha' etc. It mentions Yajnas (i.e. sacrifices)—Ashwamedha Yajna (2 times), Rajasuya Yajna, Agnadhya Yajna etc—performed by Shatakarni. It contains the information that at the time of death of Shatakarni both his sons—Shaktishri & Vedashri—were minor, so their mother Nagagnika held the power in her hand as regent.

- **Gautami Balashri's Nasik Cave Prashasti Inscription (141 AD)** : It is found from a cave of Nasiknagar of Maharashtra state. It throws light on Satavahana ruler Gautamiputra Shatakarni (106-130 AD). It was inscribed in 141 AD by his mother Gautami Balashri in the reign of Vashishthiputra Pulumavi (130-154 AD). Due to this reason, this inscription is sometimes known as Vashishthiputra Pulumavi's Nasik Prashasti Inscription. This inscription throws light on victories of Gautamiputra Shatakarni and his devotion towards the religion. According to the inscription, he took up the title of 'Khatiya-dap-man-madanas', 'Saka-Yavan-Palhav-Nisudanam', 'Khakharat - Vas - Niravases - Karas', 'Satavahana - Kula Yas-Patithapan-Karas' etc. He also took up the title of 'Tri-Samudra-Toya-Pita-Vahana' i.e., one whose horses drank the waters of three seas in the East, West and South (identified as the Bay of Bengal, the Arabian Sea & the Indian Sea).
- **Mathura Stone Pillar Inscription of Huwishka's Time (106 AD)** : It is inscribed on the pillar found from a red well near Chaurasi Jain Temple at Mathura in Mathura district of Uttar Pradesh state. At present this inscription is conserved in Mathura Museum. It is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script. It was inscribed by a donor namely Sarakman of Kushan's ruler Huwishka's time. It states a chief who deposited money as a 'Akshaynivi' (i.e. permanent amount whose interest only can be spend not the principal) to a guild of floor millers for the maintenance of 100 Brahmanas out of the monthly interest on it. The last line of this inscription states that the pious fruit of this grant firstly goes to the king Huwishka—it displays the respect to the king in the minds of general people.
- **Ushabhadata's Nasik Cave Inscription (1st Century AD)** : It is inscribed in Dhasami cave of Pandu Lena in Nasik city of Maharashtra state. It is written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script. It was inscribed by Ushabhadata, son-in-law of Kshaharata ruler of Nasik Nahpan. It defines the boundaries of Nahpan state. It contains the information about the guild system of that time. According to the inscription, Ushabhadata deposited 3,000 Kahapana (Karshapana) as a 'Akshayanivi' (i.e., permanent amount) in which 2,000 Kahapana to weaver's guild of Govardhana and 1,000 Kahapana other weavers' guild. The interest of this amount can be spend for clothes and other things of Bhikshus who resided in the Dhasami Cave of Pandu Lena.
- **Rudradaman's Junagadh/Girnar Inscription (150 AD)** : It is inscribed on a stone-piece which is situated at Girnar hills near Junagadh city of Gujarat state. It is written in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script. It is the first long Sanskrit inscription of India. It was inscribed by Saka ruler Rudradaman. According to the inscription, Rudradaman defeated various kings and annexed their states—Akara (East Malwa), Avanti (West Malwa), Anupa, Anarta (North Kathiawar), Saurashtra (South Kathiawar), Subhra (the region on the Sabarmati), Maru (Marwar), Kuccha (Cutch), Sindhu (East of the lower Indus), Suvira (West of the lower Indus), Kukura, Aparant (North Konkan) & Nisbada (West Vindhya & Aravali). From this inscription we get the history

of Sudarsana Lake. According to this inscription, the Sudarsana Lake which existed from the time of Chandragupta Maurya and Ashoka (Pushyagupta, the provincial governor of Chandragupta Maurya built the Sudarsana Lake and Yonraj Tushak (Iranian), the provincial governor of Ashoka repaired this lake) burst in time of Rudradaman. There was a lot of destruction. Sudarsana became Dudarsana. Rudradaman repaired this lake from his own pocket and had not imposed any tax on the public. The repairing work was done under the supervision of Suvishakh, the provincial governor of Rudradaman. This is the first inscription in which for the first time Laxmi along with Vishnu is mentioned.

Inscriptions of Gupta Period

- **Samudragupta's Prayag (Allahabad) Prashasti Inscription (360 AD)** : This pillar inscription stands inside the fort at Allahabad and not in its original place of Prayag (Kosambi). The Prashasti (i.e. eulogy) inscribed on it was composed by Harishena the Mahasandhivigrahi (the minister of peace and war) of Samudragupta. It is written in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script. The earlier part of the inscription is composed in verse while the later part of the inscription is in prose. It throws light on the coronation of Samudragupta, his conquests in all directions and his personality. There is a long sentence running into 33 lines in it. The content of 7th-8th line—Announcement of Chandragupta-I at the court that Samudragupta will be his successor, jealousy felt by 'Tulyakulajas' due to coronation of Samudragupta; Content of 13th line—Victory over Achyut and Nagasena, annexation of Pataliputra; Content of 17th-18th line—Samudragupta described as 'one whose only ally was valour (Parakrama) through the might of his own arm', 'whose body is covered with scar-marks caused by various weapons'; Content of 19th-20th line—Victory over 12 rulers of Dakshinapatha; Content of 21st line—defeating of 9 rulers of Naga dynasty at Kosambi; Content of 22nd line—Victory over Atawik, subordination accepted by 5 states of Eastern border region; Content of 24th line—Subordination accepted by Kider-Kushan ruler Devaputra Shahi Shahanushahi, Saka ruler Rudrasena-III, Saka-Murund ruler, Sinhali (Sri Lankan) king Meghavarna, Jawa, Sumatra & Malay islands; Content of 27th line—Samudragupta described as 'Kaviraja' because he was so expert in music that Narad and Tumburu were ashamed; Content of 28th line—Samudragupta described as 'Patron of Scholars'; Content of 29th-30th line—Samudragupta described as 'Lichchhavi Dauhitra', 'Maharajadhiraja', 'Avtar (incarnation) of Vishnu', 'Prachir (wall) bound with Dharma' (religion) etc.
- **Samudragupta's Eran Inscription** : In this inscription Samudragupta is called 'Sarvarajochchheta' (i.e. uprooter of all kings). According to this inscription he was married with Datta Devi. It states that 'Erikini' (i.e. Eran) was his 'Swabhoganagar' (i.e. personal Jagir).
- **Samudragupta's Nalanda Copper Plate Inscription** : It is found from a 'Vihar' (i.e. monastery) in Nalanda of Bihar state. It is written in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script. This copper plate inscription of donative nature contains the conditions on which 'Agrahar

(i.e. land grant) had been given to Brahmanas by the donor. It contains the Gupta genealogy (from Srigupta to Samudragupta).

- **Samudragupta's Gaya Copper Plate Inscription** : It is found from Gaya of Bihar state. The content of this inscription is similar to the content of his Nalanda copper plate inscription.
- **Chandragupta-II's Udaygiri Inscription** : It is inscribed on two caves at Udaygiri hills near Vidisha of Madhya Pradesh state. The first cave was carved by a feudatory belonging to Sankhik region of Chandragupta-II and the second cave by Veersen Shab, Sandhivigrikh (minister of peace and war) of Chandragupta-II. This inscription throws light on victory over western region by Chandragupta-II.
- **Chandra's Meharauli (Delhi) Iron Pillar Inscription** : It is concerned with the king named Chandra (identified as the Gupta ruler Chandragupta-II by scholars mostly).
- **Kumargupta-I's Damodarpur Copper Plate Inscription** : It is found from Damodarpur in Dinajpur district of Northern Bengal. It is written in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script. This inscription confirms that Northern Bengal was a part of Kumargupta-I's empire. It throws light on state organisation and administrative system of Gupta period.
- **Kumargupta-I's Mandsore Stone Inscription** : It is inscribed on a stone-piece of an embankment at Sivana river in Mandsore of Madhya Pradesh. It throws light on decline of commerce and industries in Later Gupta Period. This inscription describes that a guild of silk-weavers migrated from Lat (Southern Gujarat) to Dashpur (Mandsore) due to the decline in silk industry. They settled in Dashpur (Mandsore) and constructed there a temple dedicated to god Surya (i.e. the Sun).
- **Skandagupta's Gimar/Junagadh Inscription** : It throws light on the provincial administration of Skandagupta. It describes the appointment of 'Gopta' (i.e. Provincial Governor) and the qualities of an ideal 'Gopta'. It contains the information that the embankment of Sudarsana Lake was damaged once again and it was repaired by Chakrapalita [the Purapati (i.e. head of the city) of Gimar city and son of Parnadatta, the 'Gopta' of Saurashtra. In this inscription Kumargupta is described as 'Kalyankari Raja (i.e. benovolent king) and Chakrapalita as 'Adarsh Nagar Rakshak' (i.e. Ideal city protector).
- **Skandagupta's Bhitari Pillar Inscription** : It is inscribed on a pillar which is situated outside the Bhitari village in Ghazipur district of Uttar Pradesh state. It is written in Sanskrit language and Brahmi script. It describes the erection of pillar, the construction of a temple in which the statue of Bhagwan Sharni (i.e. God Vishnu) was established and donation of revenue received from Bhitari village for the expenses of temple by Skandagupta. It contains the Gupta genealogy (from Srigupta to Skandagupta). It mentions the invasion of Huns.
- **Skandagupta's Indore Copper Plate Inscription** : It contains the information about a Saur Sampradaya (i.e. community concerned with the Sun), Tailika Shreni

(i.e. Guild of oil-millers) that worked like a bank and an administrative unit named 'Antarvedi' and their administrator 'Sharvanaga'.

- **Bhanugupta's Eran Stone Inscription (510 AD)** : It is found from Eran in Sagar district of Madhya Pradesh. It describes the battle between Bhanugupta and Hun invader Tormana. Goparaj, a feudatory of Bhanugupta, was killed during the battle and his wife entered the mass of fire (funeral pyre). This is the first archaeological evidence of Sati-Pratha (i.e. the custom of immolation of a widow after the death of her husband) in ancient India.
- **Tormana's Eran Varah Statue Inscription** : It is inscribed on a statue of Varah found from Eran (Sagar district, Madhya Pradesh). It describes political achievements and religious interest of Hun ruler Tormana.

Later Inscriptions

- **Harshavardhana's Banskhara Copper-Plate Inscription** : It is found in Banskhara in Shahjehanpur district of Uttar Pradesh. It throws light on the administration and economy of Harshavardhana. It gives account of the donation of taxfree village namely Markat (Vishaya-Angdiya, Bhukti—Ahichhotra) to two Brahmanas by Harshavardhana. It contains the replica of signature of Harshavardhana that clarifies that he was a good calligraphist.
- **Yashodharmana's Mandsore Stone Pillar Inscription** : It was inscribed by Malwa ruler Yashodharmana. According to this inscription, he defeated Hun ruler Mihirkula and annexed Malwa.
- **Mihirbhoja's Gwalior Prashasti Inscription** : It was inscribed by Pratihara King Mihirbhoja. In the inscription, Mihirbhoja is described as a great conqueror, competent administrator and benevolent ruler.
- **Parmara Bhoja's Dhara Prashasti Inscription** : It throws light on political and cultural achievements of Bhoja of Parmara Dynasty.
- **Vijayasen's Devpara Prashasti Inscription** : It describes the events that occurred during the reign of Vijayasen, the founder of Sen dynasty.

II. South Indian Inscriptions

- **Pulkeshin-II's Aihole Prashasti Inscription** : It is inscribed in Vishnu temple at Aihole in Bagalkot district of Karnataka state. It is an eulogy and written by the court poet of Pulkeshin-II and Jain follower Ravikriti. It throws light on the successes of Pulkeshin-II, the Chalukya ruler of Vatapi/Badami. This inscription begins with an invocation to Jinendra (lord of the Jinas). According to the inscription, Pulkeshin-II defeated Harshavardhana on the bank of Narmda and checked Harsha's campaign to conquer Deccan. On this occasion, Pulkeshin-II took up the title 'Parameshwar'. In this inscription Ravikriti describes himself as the equal of Kalidasa and Bhasa. According to the inscription, the Mahabharat war was fought in 3101 BC.
- **Narsinghvarmana's Mallikarjuna Temple Stone Inscription** : It contains the conquest of Pallava ruler Narsinghvarmana over Chalukya ruler of Badami Pulkeshin-II. On this occasion Narsinghvarmana took up the title 'Mahamalla'.

- > **Dantidurg's Allora Cave Inscription** : It is inscribed in Dashavtar Temple of Allora. It describes the conquests of Rashtrakuta ruler Dantidurg over Kalinga, Koshal, Kanchi Malaw, Lat, Tank etc.
- > **Rajaraja's Tanjore Inscription** : It throws light on the successes of Chola king Rajaraja. (Note—Rajaraja was the first Indian king who conceived the idea of Inscription begin with historical preface/introduction). According to the Inscription Rajaraja defeated Chera in the battle of Kandaloor. He annexed Northern Sri Lanka.
- > **Rajendra-I's Tiruvalangar Copper Inscription** : It describes the victories of Chola ruler Rajendra-I. According to the inscription, Rajendra-I defeated Sumatra ruler Vijayottung Varmana. It contains the information about the revenue system of Cholas.
- > **Uttarmerur Inscription of Parantaka time** : It contains the details about local government prevalent during Chola period.

B. Coins

- > Coins help us a great deal to know the history of ancient India.
- > These coins confirm, revise, change or extend the facts received from literary sources.
- > Coins are of various metals—copper, silver, gold and others.
- > For convenience of study, coins are divided into two categories—Indigenous & Foreign.

(i) Indigenous Coins

(a) Early Punch-Marked Coins

- > Early coins of India are Punch-marked coins. They are called punch-marked because pieces of metal were punched with certain marks/symbols, such as a hill, tree, fish, bull, elephant, crescent etc.
- > Punch-marked coins have no inscription, but only marks.
- > The earliest punch-marked coins were made largely of silver, though a few copper coins also existed.
- > The punch-marked coins were made largely in quadrilateral shape.
- > The punch-marked coins (i.e. coins made of metal) appear first in the 6th Century BC. These coins were in circulation for around four centuries—from 6th Century to 2nd Century BC (i.e. from Mahajanapadas period to Shung period).
- > The Punch-marked coins were issued first by the Guilds of merchants, later by States.

(b) Indo-Bactrian Coins

- > The practice of writing the names of kings and the figures of the rulers, deities etc was started by the Indo-Bactrian kings, the rulers of North-Western India.
- > The writings on the coins included the names of the kings, their titles, their personal interests, religious beliefs etc. The figures of the kings were encased on the front side of the coins while the figures of the deities were encased on the back side of the coins.
- > Actually these were the coins that enabled us to construct the complete history of Indo-Bactrian rulers. The classical writers refer to only four or five Indo-Bactrian rulers and in the absence of these coins,

the names of other Indo-Bactrian rulers would have remained absolutely unknown.

- > Besides this, it was the Indo-Bactrian rulers who first of all issued the gold coin.
 - > The Indo-Bactrian coins possess a high degree of excellence in many ways and ultimately had a tremendous influence on Indian coinage.
- (c) **Scythian (Saka), Parthian (Pahlava) & Kushana Coins**
- > After Indo-Bactrians, Scythian (Saka), Parthian (Pahlava) and Kushana rulers had ruled over North-Western India. They issued coins in the analogy of Indo-Bactrian coins.
 - > These coins played key-role in constructing the history of Scythian (Saka), Parthian (Pahlava) & Kushana rulers.

The existence of the Malavas, Yaudheyas and the Mitra rulers of Panchala is known only from the coins.

- > First of all, Saka Strap Rudradaman (130-50 AD) issued dated coins in Sanskrit.
- > The Satavahana rulers issued their coins in lead (mainly), copper, bronze & potin.
- > The Kushana ruler were the first rulers in India who issued gold coins regularly and on a large scale. Among gold coins of ancient rulers of India the gold coins of Kushan rulers contain the most purity.

(d) Gupta Coins

- > The Gupta rulers issued the largest number of gold coins.
- > Among Gupta rulers **Chandragupta-I** was the first ruler who first of all issued the gold coins. He issued only one type of gold coins—King-Queen type or Chandragupta-Kumardevi type.

Original types of gold coins of **Samundragupta**—Garud type, Dhanurdhari i.e. Archer type, Axe type, Ashvamedha type, Vyaghrahanan i.e. Tiger-killing type & Veenavadan i.e. flute playing type; Original types of gold coins of **Chandragupta-II**, '**Vikramaditya**'—Ashvarohi type, Chhatradhari type & Chakra-Vikram type; Original type of gold coins of **Kumargupta-I**—Khadagadhari type, Gajarohi type, Gajarohi Sinhihanta type, Khang-nihanta i.e. rhinoceros-slayer type, Kartikeya type & Apratigh-mudra type.

- > Among the Gupta rulers, Chandragupta-II '**Vikramaditya**' was the first ruler who issued silver coins.
- > Among the Gupta rulers, Ramgupta was the first and only one ruler who issued copper coins.
- > The gold coins of Gupta rulers is known as 'Dinars' where as the silver coins of Gupta rulers as 'Rupak'.
- > After decline of the Guptas and before the foundation of Delhi Sultanate, Indian currency have suffered a bad phase. It is evident that we get few coins of the succeeding dynasties in the North India as well as South India.

II. Foreign Coins

- > The gold and silver coins of Roman emperors are found from various parts of South India especially in Arikmendu (near Pondicherry), Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh & Tamil Nadu. These coins are of the period of Roman emperor Augustus (27 BC-14 AD) & Tiberius (14-37 AD).